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Rev. E. F. J. Casey

In Baltimore he had gone to St. Agnes Hospital for treatment on his carbuncle and had afterwards requested the authorities to get him to the B. & O. Depot for Chicago. Instead, however, they had sent him out to said retreat, conscientiously, no doubt - providentially, I trust - convinced that he was in no fit condition to be traveling alone. Indeed, the more we have learned about that institution and the more I've considered his condition, both at the time and since, the more too am I convinced that he could hardly have landed in a better or a more providential place. Deo Gratias

At all events, we at the Monastery here looked upon his going thither as an answer to prayer and as nothing less than evidence that he was in God's guidance. Only later, it dawned on my mind that my simple proposition -- as said above -- to pray, rather than simply read the "Coronation" was, possibly, being considered too.

But where the connection between reading a book and the obtaining of such a favor? Why urge such reading? Why suggest it as a last remedy when everything else seems futile? This might seem quite a question to ask, and, as a rule, questions are more easily asked than answered.

It ought to be self understood that no simple reading of any book is going to move the Heart of Heaven in our favor. Only inasmuch as any book or page can serve to raise the heart to God and thus draw His blessings to us can it be said to have any quality of prayer about it. But, besides this, to profit by reading, even the holiest prayers - even about God Himself - the heart of the reader must be disposed. In other words, if we want to profit by our reading about God and his saints, we must read with reverence. We must appreciate. We speak of the Holy Bible, the Holy Gospel, etc., because the Church has declared them to be inspired writings and because millions have profited from their perusal; have learned to believe in God and to love Him by devoutly reading about Him therein. Others have read the same holy pages without profit; others again, to their own detriment. Why so? How? Failure of disposition; Want of reverence. "Unlearned and unstable wresting the scriptures to their own destruction.

Now, in my opinion, there is hardly another book written outside the Bible itself more "inspired-like and more inspiring than this wonderful work," The Mystical City of God." Its introduction alone,